

ROOM · KR-001

THE KITCHEN

SEVEN ZONES. START AT THE SINK.

The kitchen is seven small places, not one big job.

ZONE · KZ-001

PRIMARY PREP COUNTER

ZONE 1 OF 7 · KITCHEN

ONE CLEAR RUN. THE REST GOES SOMEWHERE ELSE.

The stretch of counter where food is actually cut, mixed, and plated.

ZONE · KZ-002

COOKING ZONE

ZONE 2 OF 7 · KITCHEN

HANDS BUSY, HEAT ON. EVERYTHING WITHIN ONE REACH.

The step of space either side of the burners where cooking happens with your hands busy and heat already on.

ZONE · KZ-003

SINK AND DISHWASHING ZONE

ZONE 3 OF 7 · KITCHEN

THE WHOLE KITCHEN RESETS FROM HERE.

The washing point for dishes, hands, and produce, and the place the whole kitchen resets from.

ZONE · KZ-004

UPPER CABINET ZONE

ZONE 4 OF 7 · KITCHEN

DAILY THINGS AT DAILY HEIGHT.

Light storage at eye level and above for the dishes you reach for every day.

ZONE · KZ-005

LOWER CABINET AND COOKWARE ZONE

ZONE 5 OF 7 · KITCHEN

OUT IN ONE MOTION. BACK IN ONE MOTION.

Deep, low storage for the heavy pieces: pots, pans, lids, bakeware, and the big bowls.

ZONE · KZ-006

UTENSIL AND UTILITY DRAWERS

ZONE 6 OF 7 · KITCHEN

ONE DRAWER. ONE JOB.

The shallow drawers holding hand tools: flatware, spatulas, peelers, measuring spoons, foil and wraps.

ZONE · KZ-007

REFRIGERATOR AND FREEZER

ZONE 7 OF 7 · KITCHEN

SEE WHAT YOU OWN BEFORE YOU SHOP.

Cold storage that has to keep food safe and show you what you already own before you shop.

FRICTION · KF-001

THE COUNTER IS NEVER CLEAR

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“I wipe it on Sunday and by Tuesday it is gone again.”

FRICTION · KF-002

I COOK ON A CHOPPING BOARD OF SPACE

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“There is a metre of counter and I use twenty centimetres of it.”

FRICTION · KF-003

MAIL AND HOMEWORK LAND HERE

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“It is the first flat surface anyone meets, so it takes everything.”

FRICTION · KF-004

I HUNT FOR THE TURNER WITH THE PAN HOT

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“The oil is smoking and I am opening the third drawer.”

FRICTION · KF-005



NOWHERE TO PUT A HOT PAN DOWN

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“I stand holding it, looking round my own kitchen, arm aching.”

FRICTION · KF-006



I BUY SPICES I ALREADY OWN

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“Three jars of cumin, and I bought two of them this year.”

FRICTION · KF-007



THE SINK IS FULL AGAIN BY EVENING

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“Empty at eight in the morning, a mountain at six.”

FRICTION · KF-008



UNDER THE SINK IS A CHEMICAL JUMBLE

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“I move four bottles to find the one I want, and I could not tell you what half of them are.”

FRICTION · KF-009



THE SPONGE SMELLS

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“It is always wet, and it never seems to be a new one.”

FRICTION · KF-010



I MOVE THREE MUGS TO GET ONE

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“Every morning, before coffee, in the half dark.”

FRICTION · KF-011



I STAND ON A CHAIR FOR THE EVERYDAY PLATES

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“Or I ask somebody taller, which is worse.”

FRICTION · KF-012



GLASSES COME DOWN WHEN THE DOOR OPENS

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“Something shifts every single time, and one day it will not stop.”

FRICTION · KF-013



EVERY PAN IS UNDER THREE OTHERS

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“I take out four to cook with one, then leave them on the floor.”

FRICTION · KF-014



THE LIDS ARE A LANDSLIDE

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“They live loose and they come out sideways.”

FRICTION · KF-015



THE HEAVY POT LIVES OVER MY HEAD

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“I lift it down with both arms and hope.”

FRICTION · KF-016



THE JUNK DRAWER TAKES ANYTHING

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“It takes anything and it gives nothing back.”

FRICITION · KF-017

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I REACH FOR A SPATULA AND FIND A BLADE

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“One of these mornings that is going to be stitches.”

FRICITION · KF-018

▲

THE DRAWER WILL NOT CLOSE

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“It catches on something every time, and I shove it.”

FRICITION · KF-019

▲

WE THROW FOOD AWAY EVERY WEEK

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“Good food, bought on purpose, binned unopened.”

FRICITION · KF-020

▲

RAW MEAT SITS ABOVE THE SALAD

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“It goes wherever there was a gap when the shopping came in.”

FRICITION · KF-021

▲

THE BACK OF THE FRIDGE IS ARCHAEOLOGY

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE. THEN WHY.

“Nobody knows how long that jar has been in there.”

ROOT CAUSE · KC-001

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EXCESS

SORT FIXES THIS ONE.

More things here than the job needs.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-002

NO ASSIGNED HOME

STRAIGHTEN FIXES THIS ONE.

The thing has no defined destination, so it lands wherever the hand opens.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-003

WRONG LOCATION

STRAIGHTEN FIXES THIS ONE.

It is stored somewhere.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-004

EXCESS MOTION

STRAIGHTEN FIXES THIS ONE.

Getting it out means bending, lifting, unstacking, or moving something else first.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-005

POOR VISIBILITY

STRAIGHTEN FIXES THIS ONE.

You own it, but you cannot see it, so you buy it again or forget it.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-006

POOR ACCESSIBILITY

SAFETY FIXES THIS ONE.

The people who use it cannot reach it safely, or at all.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-007

INSUFFICIENT CAPACITY

SORT FIXES THIS ONE.

The right storage exists and genuinely cannot hold what belongs in it.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-008

MISSING STANDARD

STANDARDIZE FIXES THIS ONE.

Nobody agreed what good looks like, so everybody is right.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-009

MISSING TRIGGER

SUSTAIN FIXES THIS ONE.

The reset is a good intention with nothing to attach it to.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-010

SAFETY CONSTRAINT

SAFETY FIXES THIS ONE.

The current arrangement can hurt somebody, and that outranks tidy.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-011

POOR REPLENISHMENT

STANDARDIZE FIXES THIS ONE.

Consumables run out unnoticed, and food ages out of use unseen.

ROOT CAUSE · KC-012

CONFLICTING USERS

STANDARDIZE FIXES THIS ONE.

Two people run one zone by two designs, so it is permanently half of each.

ACTION · KA-001

CLEAR THE RUN

15 MINUTES. 1.

Get one unbroken run of counter back, and prove it can hold.

ACTION · KA-002

REBUILD THE
PREP COUNTER

30 MINUTES. 1 TO 2.

Change the counter so clear is the easy state rather than the daily effort.

ACTION · KA-003

COOKING ZONE
RESET

15 MINUTES. 1.

Put oil, salt and one turner back within a single reach, and clear the landing space.

ACTION · KA-004

REBUILD THE
COOKING ZONE

30 MINUTES. 1.

Lay the burner surround out for one reach, and take the fire risk out of it.

ACTION · KA-005

SINK RESET

15 MINUTES. 1.

Empty basin, dry basin, two tools standing.

ACTION · KA-006

REBUILD UNDER
THE SINK

30 MINUTES. 1.

One tray, the pipes visible, and nothing stored that can react with anything beside it.

ACTION · KA-007

UPPER CABINET
RESET

15 MINUTES. 1.

Daily things to daily height, one category per stack.

ACTION · KA-008

REBUILD THE UPPER CABINETS

30 MINUTES. 1 TO 2.

Band the cabinet by height so nobody climbs for anything they use every day.

ACTION · KA-009

COOKWARE RESET

15 MINUTES. 1.

The two pans you cook with nightly at the front, everything else capped at three deep.

ACTION · KA-010

REBUILD THE COOKWARE CABINET

30 MINUTES. 1.

Give the heavy pieces a floor, the lids a rack, and the sheets an edge to stand on.

ACTION · KA-011

DRAWER RESET

15 MINUTES. 1.

One drawer, one job, and it closes with one push.

ACTION · KA-012

REBUILD THE DRAWERS

30 MINUTES. 1.

Name every drawer where only the household sees it, and get the small hazards out of the low ones.

ACTION · KA-013

FRIDGE RESET

15 MINUTES. 1.

Raw low, dates on, one eat first bin at the front.

ACTION · KA-014

REBUILD THE FRIDGE

30 MINUTES. 1 TO 2.

Assign every shelf a job, and make the cold chain visible.

ACTION · KA-015

THE FIVE MINUTE CLOSE

5 MINUTES. 1, ANY NIGHT.

Leave the kitchen in a state tomorrow can start from.

ACTION · KA-016

THE HOT ZONE WALK

15 MINUTES. 1, AND ONE OTHER PERSON TO DISAGREE WITH YOU.

Six checks across the whole kitchen, and an honest answer on each.

ACTION · KA-017

THE SHOPPING LIST LOOP

15 MINUTES. EVERYONE WHO SHOPS.

Write the list from what you own instead of from what you imagine.

ACTION · KA-018

THE TWO COOK TREATY

20 MINUTES. EVERYONE WHO USES THIS KITCHEN.

One sentence about this kitchen that two people will both sign.

STANDARD · KS-001

PRIMARY PREP COUNTER STANDARD

WRITE IT. SIGN IT. PUT IT WHERE IT HAPPENS.

The clear run stays clear: one board, one knife block or strip, one seasoning within reach, and nothing parked on the...

STANDARD · KS-002

COOKING ZONE STANDARD

WRITE IT. SIGN IT. PUT IT WHERE IT HAPPENS.

Oil, salt, and your turner within one reach of the burner, no more than six tools in the crock, handles turned in...

STANDARD · KS-003

SINK AND DISHWASHING ZONE STANDARD

WRITE IT. SIGN IT. PUT IT WHERE IT HAPPENS.

Empty sink, dry basin, one brush and one sponge standing, cleaners on one tray with the plumbing visible.

STANDARD · KS-004

UPPER CABINET ZONE STANDARD

WRITE IT. SIGN IT. PUT IT WHERE IT HAPPENS.

Daily dishes between shoulder and eye height, one category per stack, top shelf reserved for what you use less than monthly.

STANDARD · KS-005

LOWER CABINET AND COOKWARE ZONE STANDARD

WRITE IT. SIGN IT. PUT IT WHERE IT HAPPENS.

Stacks capped at three, lids racked, heaviest pieces on the cabinet floor, and the two nightly pans at the front.

STANDARD · KS-006

UTENSIL AND UTILITY DRAWERS STANDARD

WRITE IT. SIGN IT. PUT IT WHERE IT HAPPENS.

One category per drawer, named inside the front edge, blades sheathed, and every drawer closing with one push.

STANDARD · KS-007

REFRIGERATOR AND FREEZER STANDARD

WRITE IT. SIGN IT. PUT IT WHERE IT HAPPENS.

Raw meat low and sealed, dated containers at eye level, one eat-first bin at the front, and the rear vents clear.

EVENT · KE-001

THE GROCERY HAUL

THE DAY THAT TESTS IT.

Twelve bags on the floor and forty minutes of cold chain.

EVENT · KE-002

WEEKNIGHT DINNER, FORTY MINUTES

THE DAY THAT TESTS IT.

Everyone is hungry, nothing is prepped, and it is a school night.

EVENT · KE-003

THE DISHWASHER IS BROKEN

THE DAY THAT TESTS IT.

Three days of washing by hand, with everyone still eating.

EVENT · KE-004

SIX DISHES AT ONCE

THE DAY THAT TESTS IT.

The holiday cook.

EVENT · KE-005

SOMEBODY IN THE HOUSE IS ILL

THE DAY THAT TESTS IT.

Cooking for a household where hygiene suddenly matters more than usual.

EVENT · KE-006

GUESTS IN THE KITCHEN

THE DAY THAT TESTS IT.

Three people and one work triangle, and none of them live here.